

Introduction to Human Communication: COMM 108
Lecture Notes OUTLINE: Ch. 6 Nonverbal Messages

I. Nonverbal Communication

A. Definition:

- **Messages expressed by anything other than linguistics**

B. Considerations:

- **No starting or stopping point with non-verbal communication**
- **You might not be intended as source or a receiver**
 - **You may send a non-verbal message you didn't even know you were sending**
 - **You might make a read on someone's non-verbal that they didn't intend to send**
- **Some non-verbals can be universal or cultural**
 - **Universal Ex: Thumbs up**
 - **Cultural Ex: Bras d'honneur**
- **They can mean many different things, this is up to the receiver to translate the non-verbal**

II. Nonverbal Categories

A. Proxemics:

1. **Proxemics is the study in the use of space**
 - i **We can assess what happens in conversation based on the use of space**

2. Territoriality:

- **Public spaces become yours for a short time when you use them**
 - **Ex: Seating arrangement in a classroom**
 - **You choose a seat that you will sit in during the duration of that class, but it is not yours when you are not occupying/using it**
- **You can mess with someone's public space at times**

- like during an elevator ride where some norms, such as personal space can be violated

3. Personal Space:

i 4 Zones:

- 1 0-18": intimate zone**
- 2 18"-4': friendship zone**
- 3 4'-8': social/business zone**
- 4 8'+: public zone**

B. Chronemics:

- **Chronemics is the study in the use of time**

1. Turn-taking:

- **American culture is very impatient**
- **1-2 seconds of waiting time between turns**

2. Waiting time:

- **How long are you willing to wait for someone**
- **5 minutes of wait time in a monochronic culture is equivalent to 45 minutes of wait time in a polychronic culture**

3. Timing of communication:

- **Invitation is based off importance**
- **Birthday cards mean you have higher importance**
- **"Sure, you can come" gives little importance**

C. Oculistics:

- **Oculistics is the study in use of our eyes during communication**
- **Eye contact changes based on the frequency or duration of communication**
 - **As frequency and duration increase interest and attention increases**

1. Used to Show:

- **Self-respect**
- **Confidence**
- **Trustworthiness**
 - **This is mainly in the U.S.**

- **When you expect someone to lie, pay attention to things that are not normalized in the culture**
 - **Ex: In U.S. culture a lot is told by eye contact/movement**
 - **Someone who is going to lie will try to control their eyes**

2. Conversation Management:

- **Initiation of communication**
- **Maintain or yield the floor**
- **Terminate conversation**
- **Initiation starts with the eyes**
 - **People give a look before beginning conversation**
 - **This look can convey whether they want to be engaged or not**
- **To maintain the conversation, we look shorter at the person we speak with**
 - **We still make eye contact, but we don't cue up their turn in the conversation**
- **When we yield, we give more eye contact**
 - **To show that we are paying attention**
- **To terminate a conversation simply look away**
 - **Termination of conversation can be awkward if you keep looking**

D. Haptics:

- **Haptics is the study in the use of touch in human communication**

1. Used to Show:

- **Touch is used to show affection**
 - **Affection does not imply sexual attraction but liking in general**
- **As affection increases there is an increase in amount of touch, duration, and location of touch**
- **10% of people are touch avoidant**
- **Touch naturally increases as the relationship grows**
 - **In both platonic and romantic relationships**

2. High and low touching cultures

- **Males are a lot more avoidant to touch with friends**
 - **Use punches to express affection**
 - **Very uncomfortable to express connection through touch**
- **As you start to dislike a person frequency of touch and duration also increase due to conflict**
- **Sidney Jourard set up research on haptics in culture:**
 - **1 hour lunch with 2 people, researchers would count the number of touches during the lunch**
- **These things differ depending on culture**

E. Kinesics:

- **Kinesics is the study of body language**

1. Posture & Movement:

- **There are ~700,000 moves and reads to make**
 - **The way you walk can show confidence**
 - **Posture can show power in a room**

2. Gestures as substitutes for words—emblems and illustrators:

- **5 categories:**
 - **Emblems:**
 - **Emblems have a direct verbal translation**
 - **we are aware of their use (thumbs up, etc.)**
 - **Illustrators:**
 - **Illustrators are used to show size, shape, or movement**
 - **We usually know we use illustrators**
 - **There is no direct verbal translation**
 - **With emblems we don't have to be part of the conversation to understand what they convey but with illustrators you need some context to understand what they mean.**

F. Physical Appearance

1. Simple Demographics:

- **How tall you are, how short you are, how big, how small, weight distribution, etc.**

- When we have nothing else to grasp at, we base our analysis on physical appearance
- Impact is short but is powerful
 - Judging a book by its cover

2. Clothing & Artifacts:

- What you choose to wear and how you wear it
- What version of the smart phone you have
- Early on in a relationship people look very good but later people begin to let on
 - This applies to both platonic and romantic relationships

G. Vocalics:

- A.K.A paralanguage
- Vocalics is the study in the use of the voice
- Volume of voice:
 - You have to be louder during a speech
- Tone:
 - Different tones of voice can send different signals
- Accent:
 - Accent that is different than a regional accent can grasp attention
- Rate:
 - How fast or slow someone talks
- Pitch:
- Pause
- Silence
- Fillers
 - “um”
 - Become self-aware of your fillers

1. As an influence on the interpretation of verbal messages:

- Nonverbal qualities make meaning out of the verbal
- Same phrase can mean 2 different things based off the verbals

2. As a provider of information about the source of the message:

- Read things based off verbal qualities
- You can get at simple demographics
 - Male/female

- **Age**
- **If they are in an emotional state**
- **Get at the cultural affiliation**
- **You cannot make a read on intelligence**